

# Principal component methods

# Readings for today

- Chapter 6: Linear model selection and regularization. James, G., Witten, D., Hastie, T., & Tibshirani, R. (2013). An introduction to statistical learning: with applications in R (Vol. 6). New York: Springer

# Topics

1. Principal components analysis
2. Factor Analysis
3. Principal component regression
4. Partial least squares



# Principal component analysis

# Dimensionality

Dimensionality of a model:  $n \times p$

As  $n \rightarrow p$ , dimensionality increases & model variance increases

$$\begin{pmatrix} x_{1,1} \\ \dots \\ x_{n,1} \end{pmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} x_{1,1} & x_{1,2} & \dots & x_{1,15} \\ \dots & & & \\ x_{n,1} & x_{n,2} & \dots & x_{n,15} \end{pmatrix} \rightarrow \uparrow \text{model flexibility}$$

How do we reduce the dimensionality of our model?

Can we do this in a way that preserved or compresses meaningful information in our feature set?

# How to deal with high model dimensionality

So far we have covered:

1. Feature selection by comparing lower dimensional variants of your model.
  - Best subset selection
  - Forward/Backward stepwise selection
2. Apply a sparsity constraint to your model during fitting.
  - Ridge regression
  - LASSO
  - Elastic Net



# Principal component analysis (PCA)

What if you reduce the dimension of  $X$  itself?

PCA:

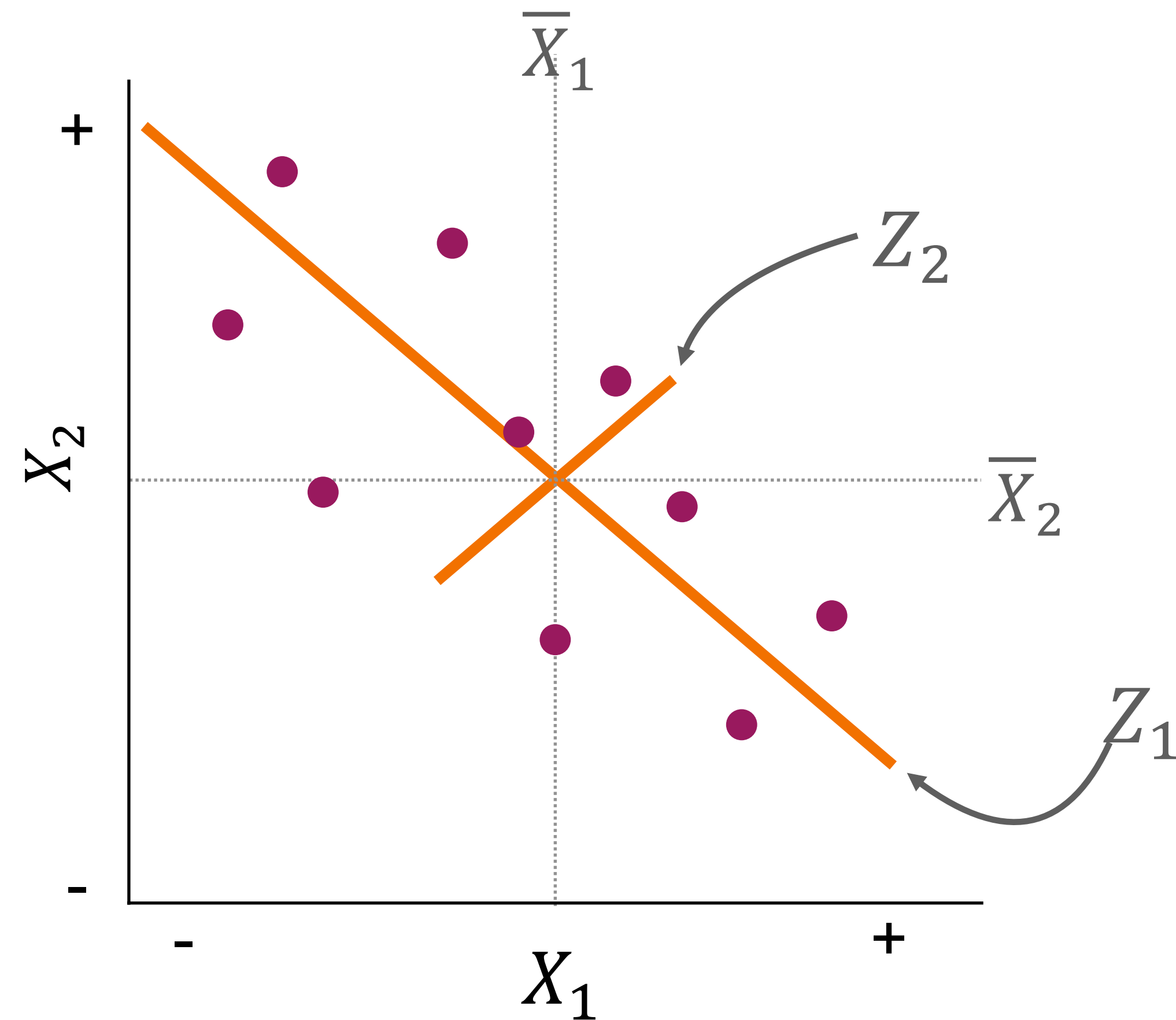
$$Z_m = \sum_{j=1}^p \phi_{j,m} X_j$$

lower dimensional projection (component)

component loading

original data variable

# Low dimensional components



The first principal component ( $Z_1$ ) explains the most variance about the relationship between  $X_1$  and  $X_2$ .



# PCA algorithm

Step 1: Find the first component ( $Z_1$ ) loading.

$$\phi_1 = \operatorname{argmax}\left(\frac{\phi_1' X' X \phi_1}{\phi_1' \phi_1}\right)$$

Step 2: Take the residuals after accounting for  $Z_1$ .

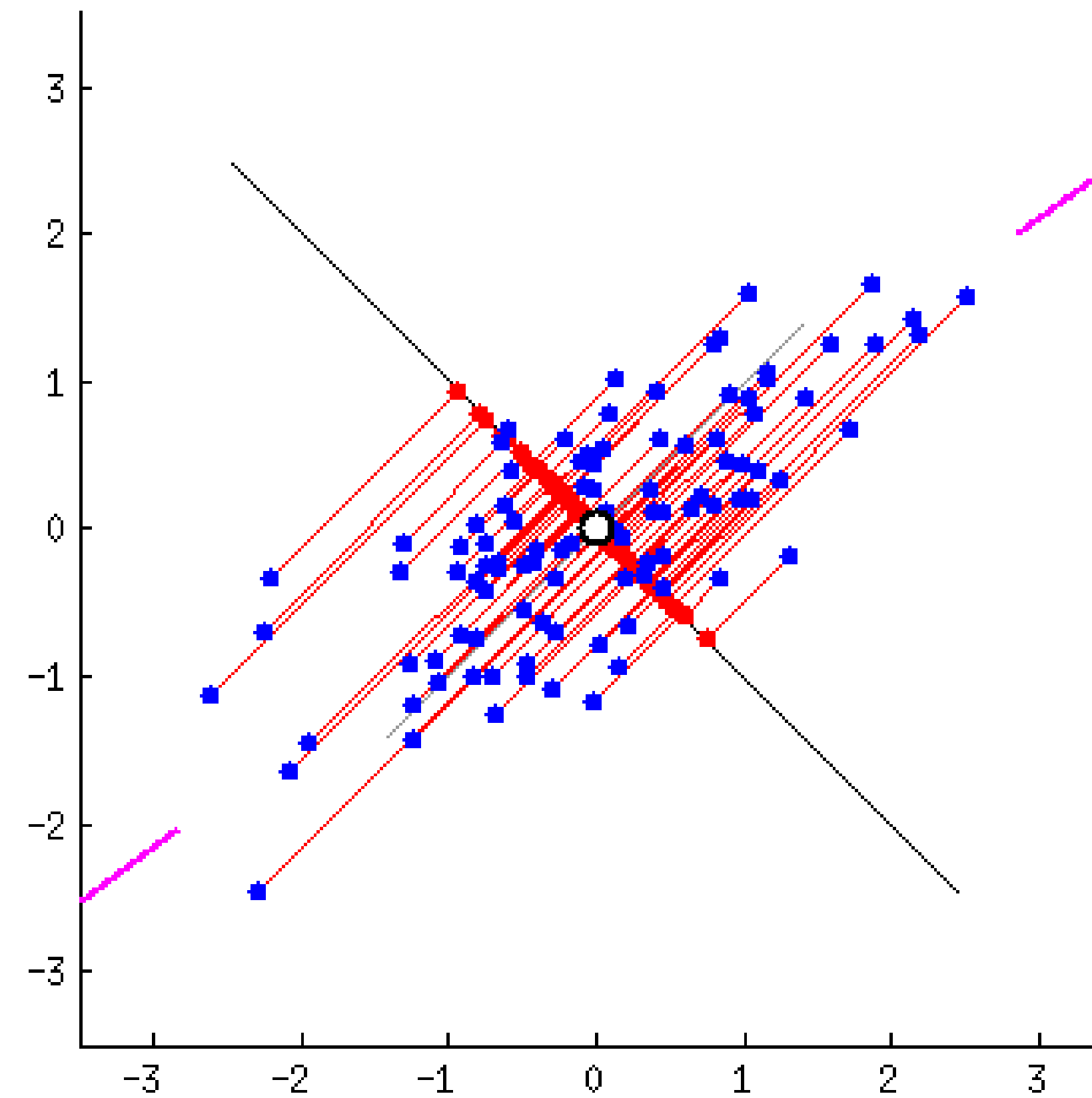
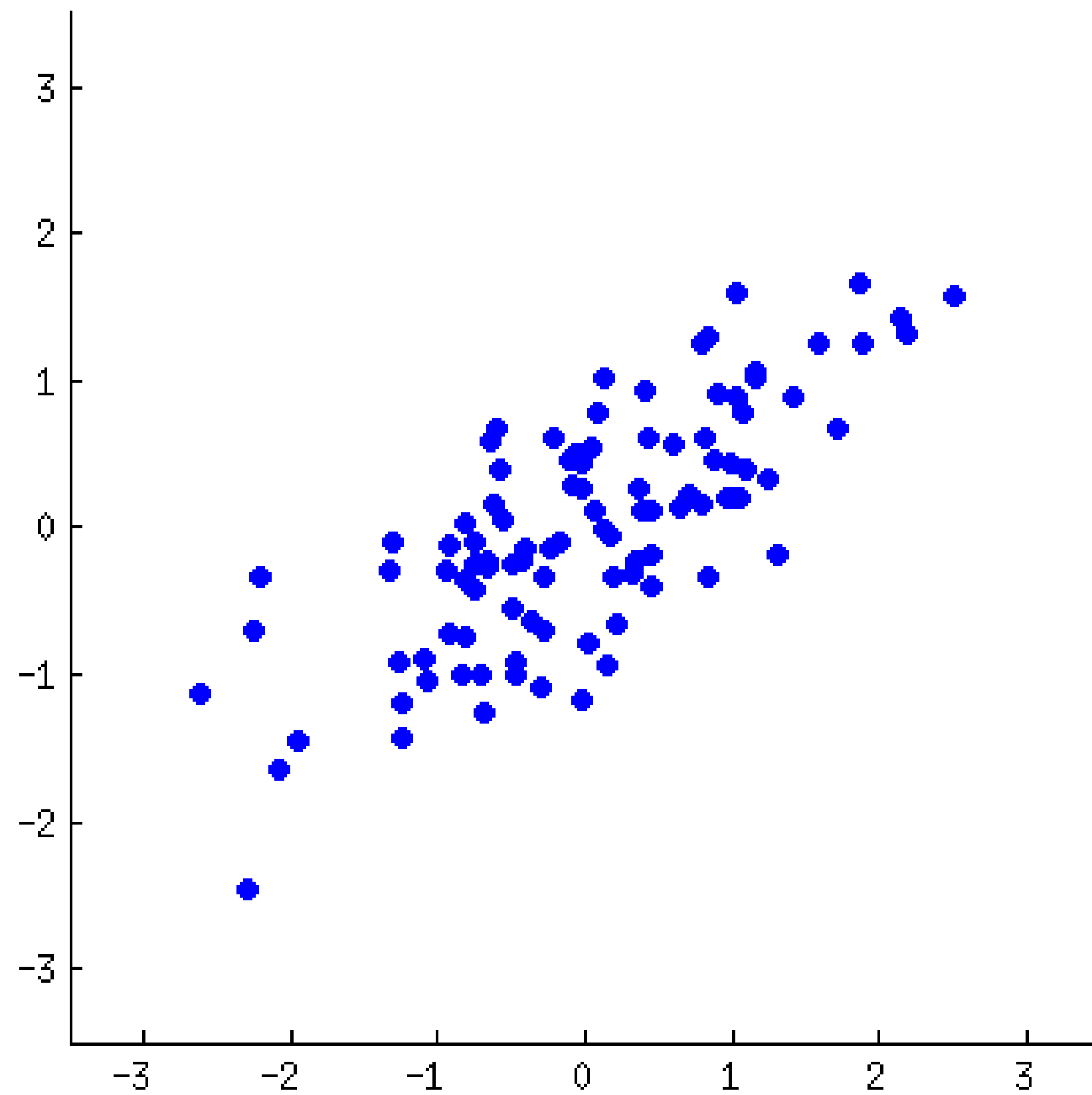
$$\hat{X}_m = X - \sum_{s=1}^{m-1} X \phi_s \phi_s'$$

Step 3: Calculate the next component ( $Z_m$ ).

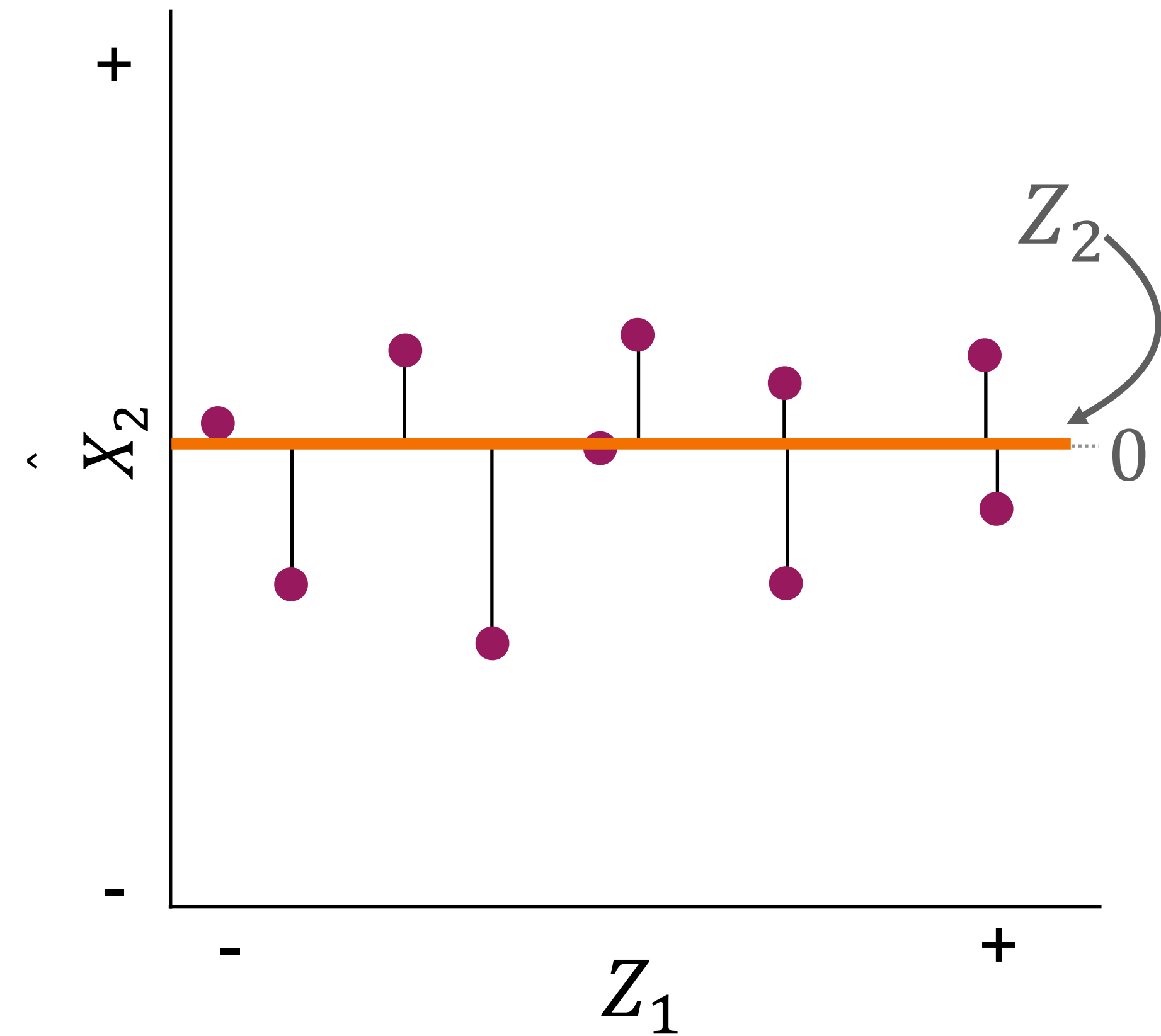
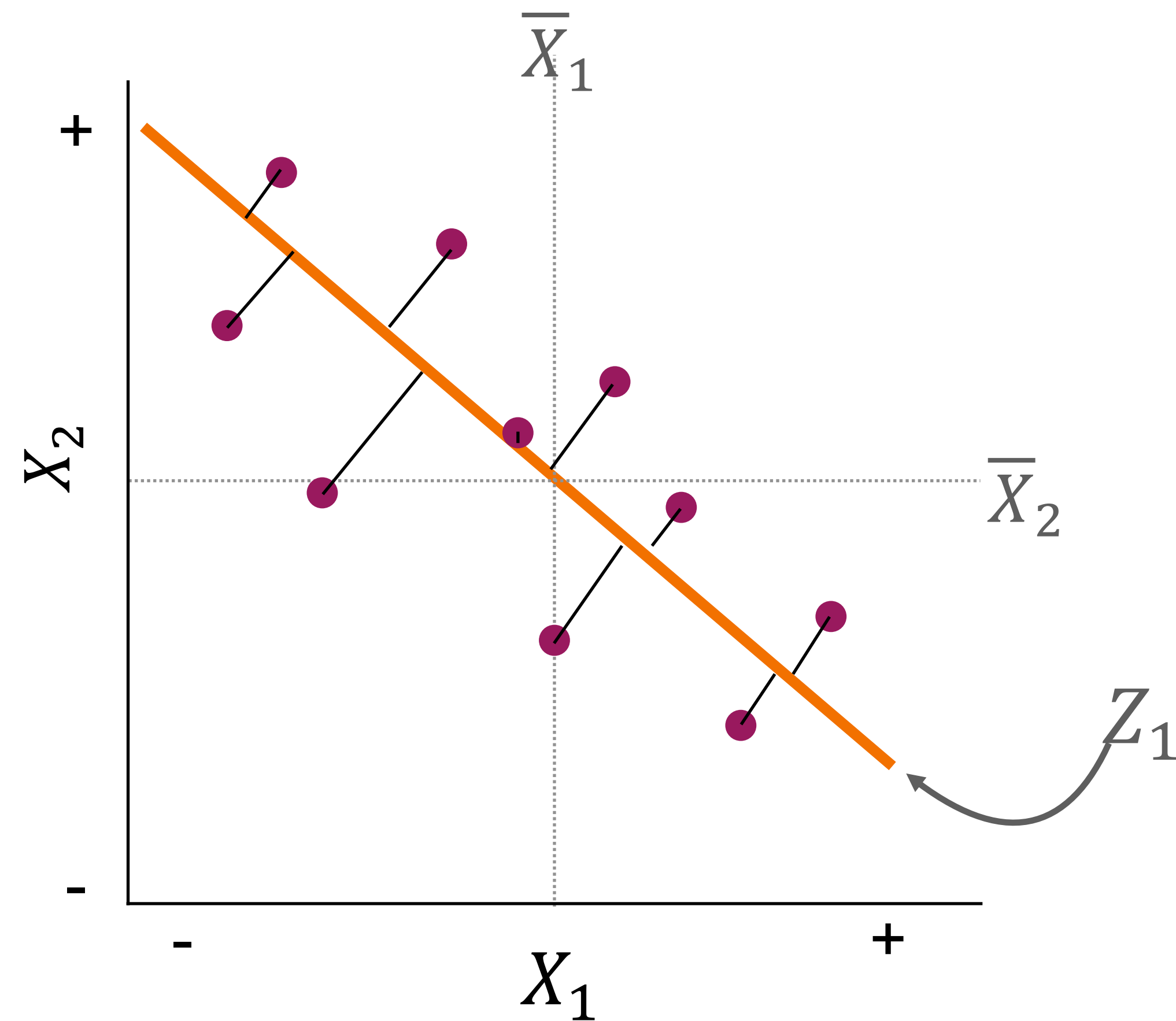
$$\phi_m = \operatorname{argmax}\left(\frac{\phi_m' \hat{X}_m' \hat{X}_m \phi_m}{\phi_m' \phi_m}\right)$$

Step 4: Repeat Steps 2-3 until  $m = p$

# PCA algorithm



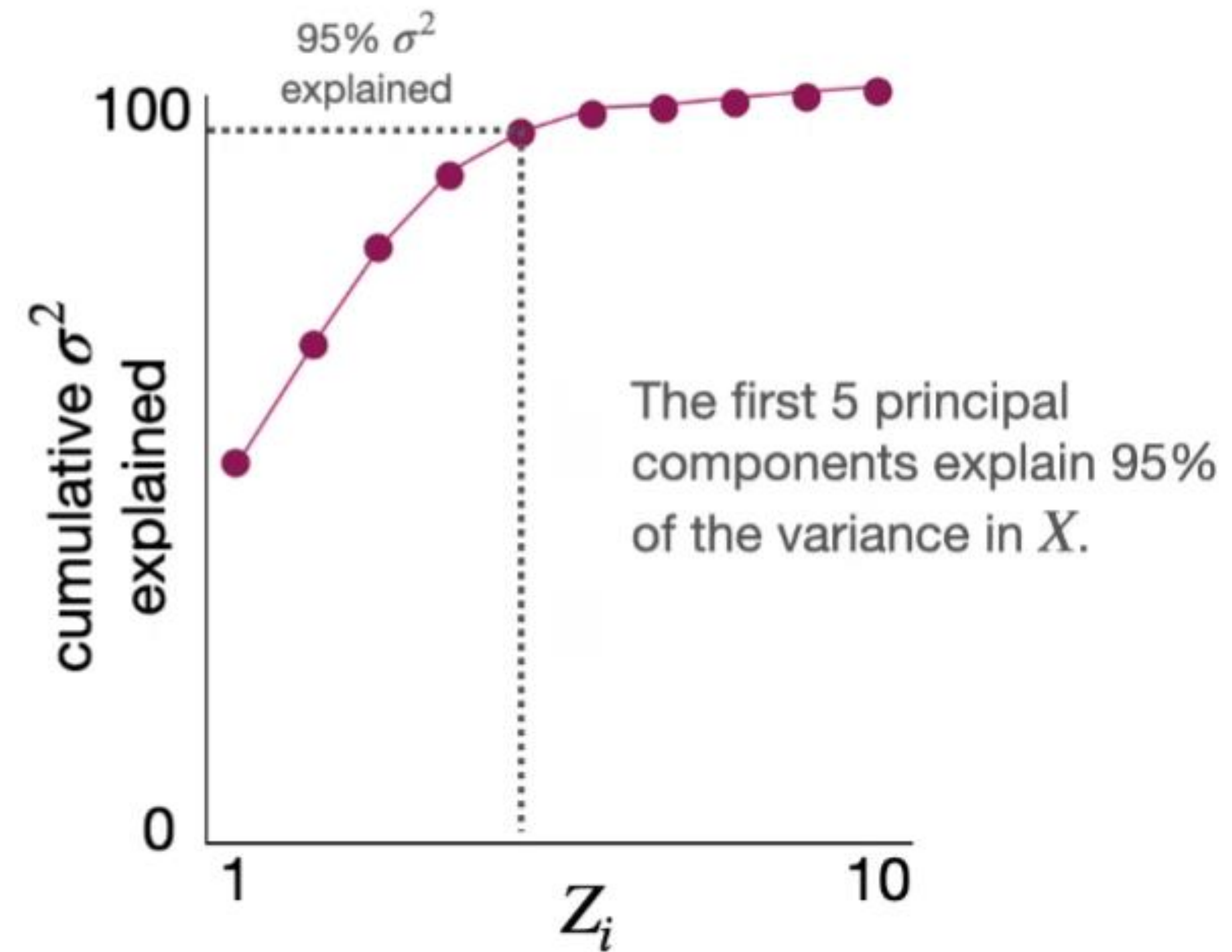
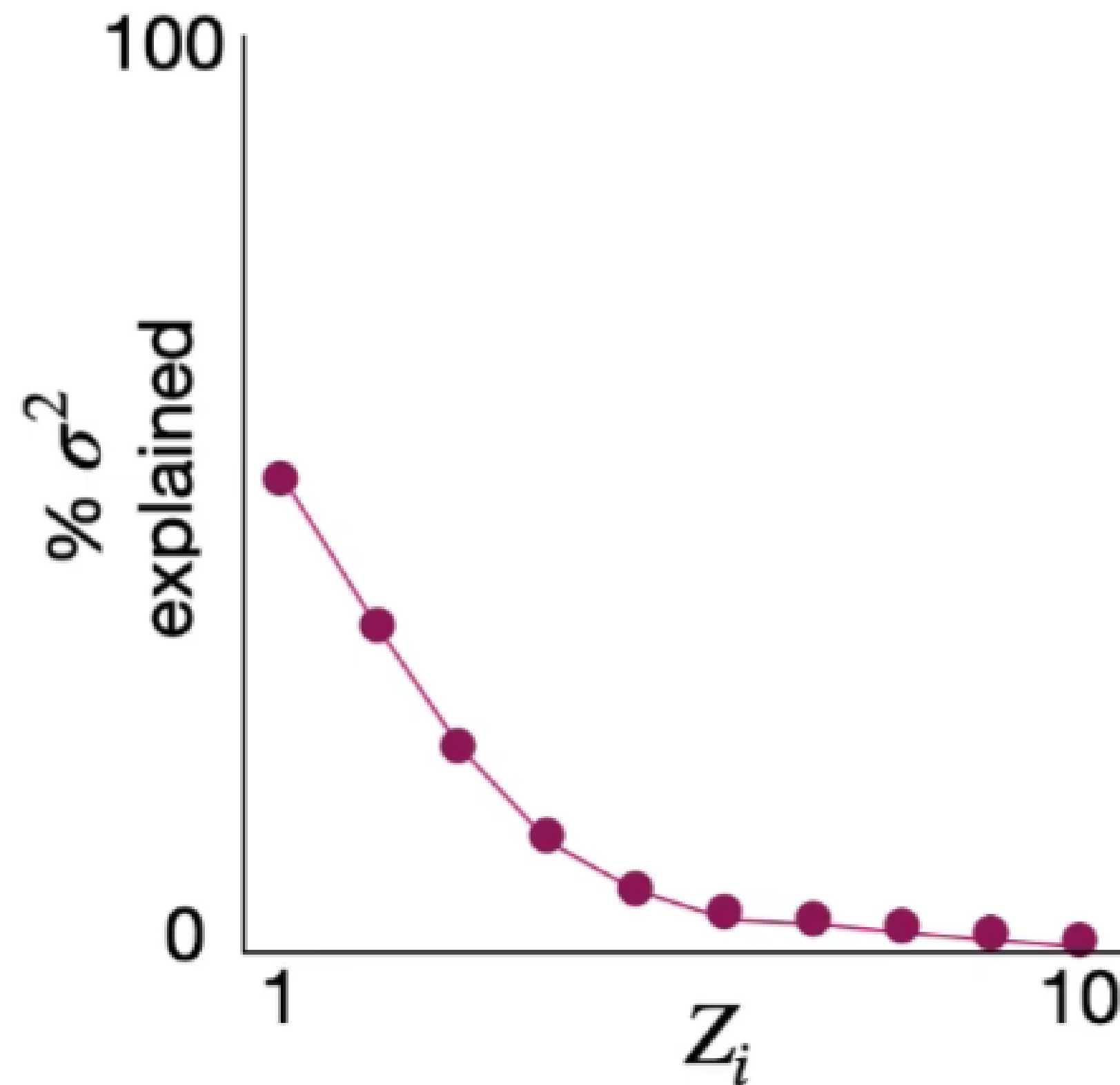
# PCA algorithm





# Example: 10-dimensional $X$

$$\begin{pmatrix} x_{1,1} & \dots & x_{1,p} \\ \vdots & & \\ x_{n,1} & \dots & x_{n,p} \end{pmatrix} \rightarrow n = 15, p = 10$$



# Factor Analysis

# Factor Analysis

Factor Analysis:  $\Sigma \approx \Lambda \Lambda' + \Psi$

$\Lambda$ :  $p \times k$  (these are your directions/'components')

$\Psi$ : diagonal noise

**Iteratively** tries to solve to  
minimize difference between  $\Sigma$  and  $\Lambda \Lambda' + \Psi$

Researcher specifies  $k$

$$\begin{matrix} X^T & = & L & F \\ p \times n & & p \times k & k \times n \end{matrix}$$

Factor loading  
matrix with  
 $k$  specified up front.



# PCA vs. Factor Analysis

PCA:

$$\underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ n \times p}}{X} = \underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ n \times m}}{Z} \underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ m \times p}}{\phi^{-1}}$$

Factor Analysis (FA):

$$\underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ p \times n}}{X^T} = \underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ p \times m}}{L} \underset{\substack{\curvearrowright \\ m \times n}}{F}$$

Are you trying to *summarize* the data, or *explain* it?

Factor loading matrix with  $m$  specified up front.

- PCA is better for summarizing or exploring your data.
- FA is better for hypothesis testing & discovering latent constructs
- PCA explains all variance in  $X$ .
- FA assumes lower dimensionality in  $X$ .

# Component/Factor Scores and Loadings

Component/Factor  
Scores:

$$n \times Z$$
$$n \times F$$

Each element is the degree that each observation aligns with the component or factor

Component/Factor  
Components:

$$p \times Z$$
$$p \times F$$

Each element is the degree that each feature aligns with the component or factor



# Principal component regression

# Principal component regression (PCR)

Goal: Reduce the dimensions of  $X$  using PCA and use the most explanatory components in  $Z$  (component **scores**) as your predictor variables.

PCA + linear regression:

The diagram illustrates the relationship between the number of components  $k$  and the total number of variables  $p$ . It shows that  $k < p$  and that  $k$  is the number of components that explain  $1 - \alpha$  percent of the variance in  $X$ . This  $k$  is then used in the regression equation  $\hat{y}_i = \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m Z_{i,m}$ , where  $\hat{\theta}_m$  are the regression coefficients learned on  $Z_1, \dots, Z_k$ .

$$\hat{y}_i = \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m Z_{i,m}$$

# PCR algorithm

Step 1: Calculate  $Z = \phi X$ .

Step 2: Identify the  $k$  components that explain  $1 - \alpha$   
(e.g.,  $(1 - 0.05) = 95\%$ ) of the variance in  $X$ .

Step 3: Fit your regression model with the  $k$  components identified in  
Step 2 (i.e., learn  $\hat{y} = Z_k \theta + \epsilon$ )



# Projecting back to $X$

Can determine the regression weights in  $X$  (i.e.,  $\hat{\beta}_j$ ) that best resolve the bias-variance tradeoff via the coefficients learning in  $Z$  (i.e.,  $\hat{\theta}_j$ )

PCR to linear regression:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{y}_i &= \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m Z_{i,m} \longrightarrow Z_m = \sum_{j=1}^p \phi_{j,m} X_j \\ &= \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m \sum_{j=1}^p \phi_{j,m} X_j \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^p \underbrace{\sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m \phi_{j,m}}_{\hat{\beta}_j} X_j \quad \beta = \phi_k \hat{\theta}\end{aligned}$$

Best regression model:

$$\hat{\beta}_j = \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m \phi_{j,m}$$

Even when  $n$  is close to  $p$ .

# Partial least squares

# Partial least squares (PLS)

Goal: Find the lower dimensions in  $X$  that *maximize*  $Cov[X, Y]$

# of variables in  $X$       # of variables in  $Z$  ( $k = p$ )

regression coefficients learned on  $Z_1, \dots, Z_k$

$$\hat{y}_i = \sum_{j=1}^p \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m \hat{\phi}_{j,m} x_{i,j}$$

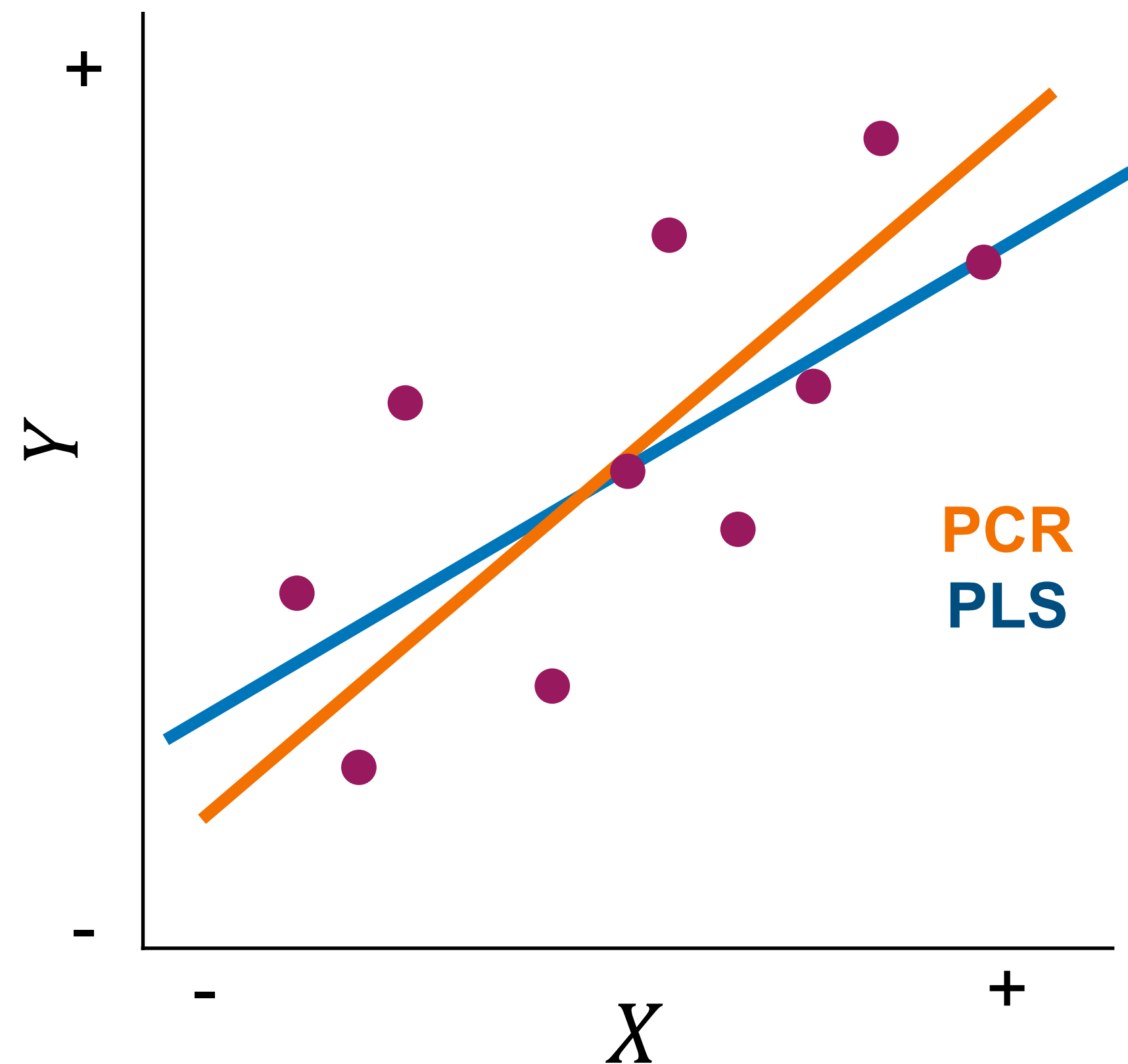
principal component loading learned by minimizing

$$\sum (y - \sum_{m=1}^k \hat{\theta}_m Z_{i,m})^2$$

$\hat{\phi}$  and  $\hat{\theta}$  estimated in one step.



# PLS vs. PCR



- PLS and PCR produce qualitatively different results depending on how the low dimensional components in  $X$  associate with  $Y$ .

# Take home message

- Principal component methods offer an easy way of resolving the bias-variance tradeoff in high dimensionality (i.e., high variance) contexts by leveraging any correlational structure in your predictor variables.